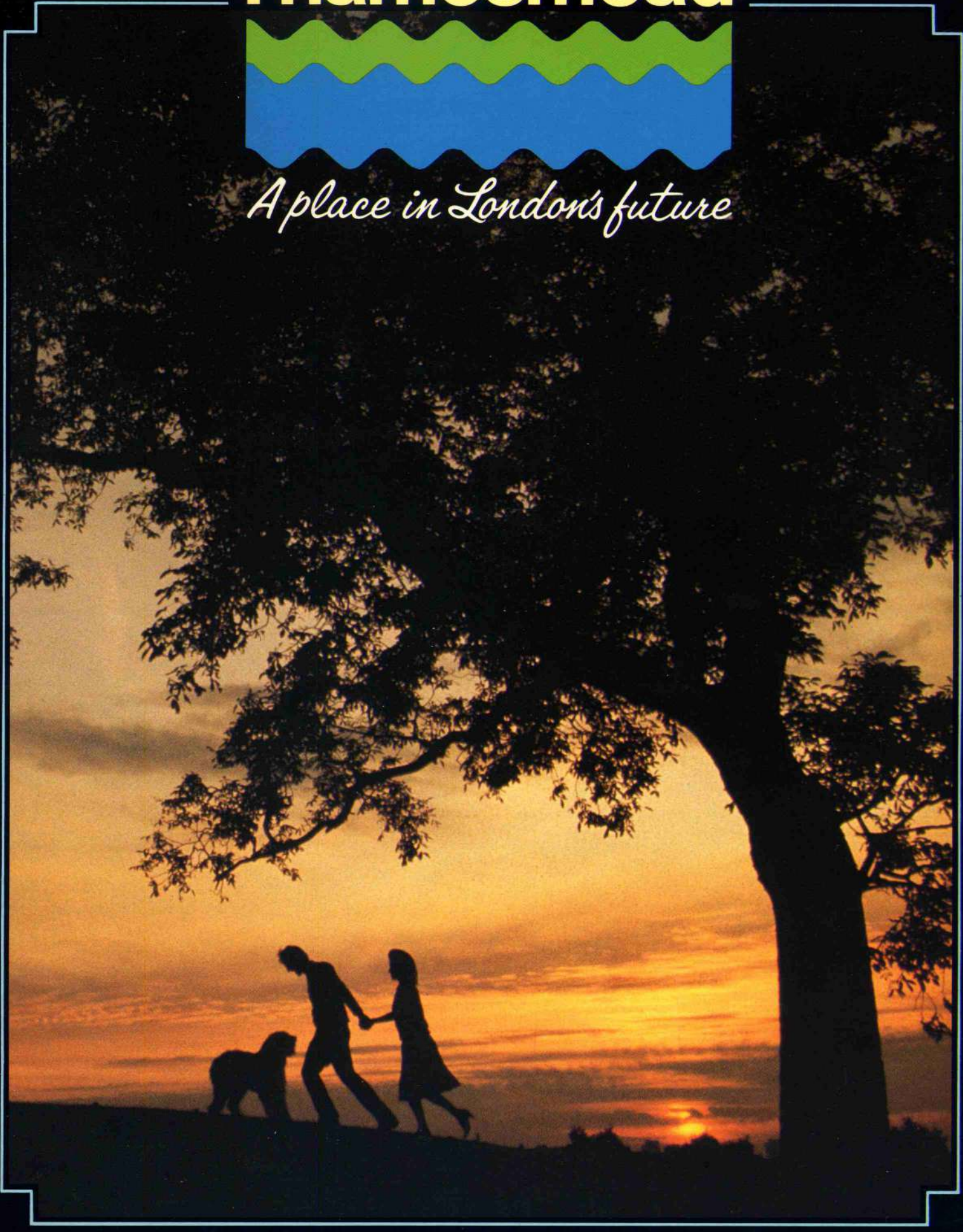
Thamesmead

A place in London's future



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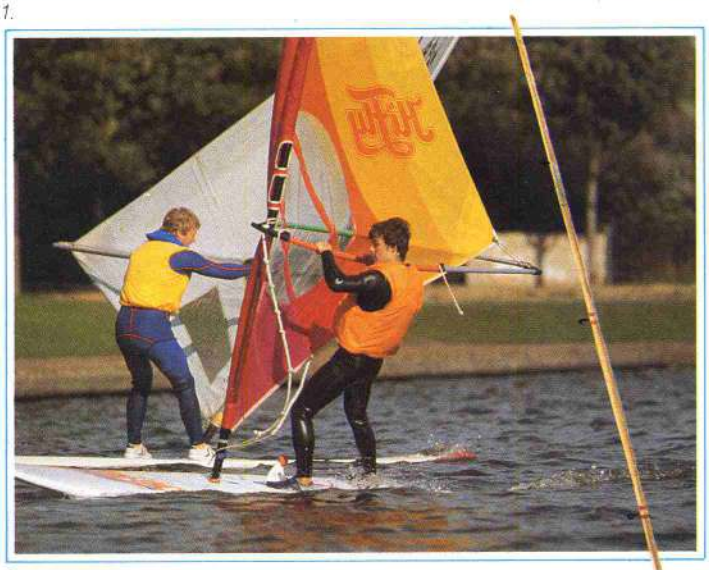
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Thamesmead

A place in London's future



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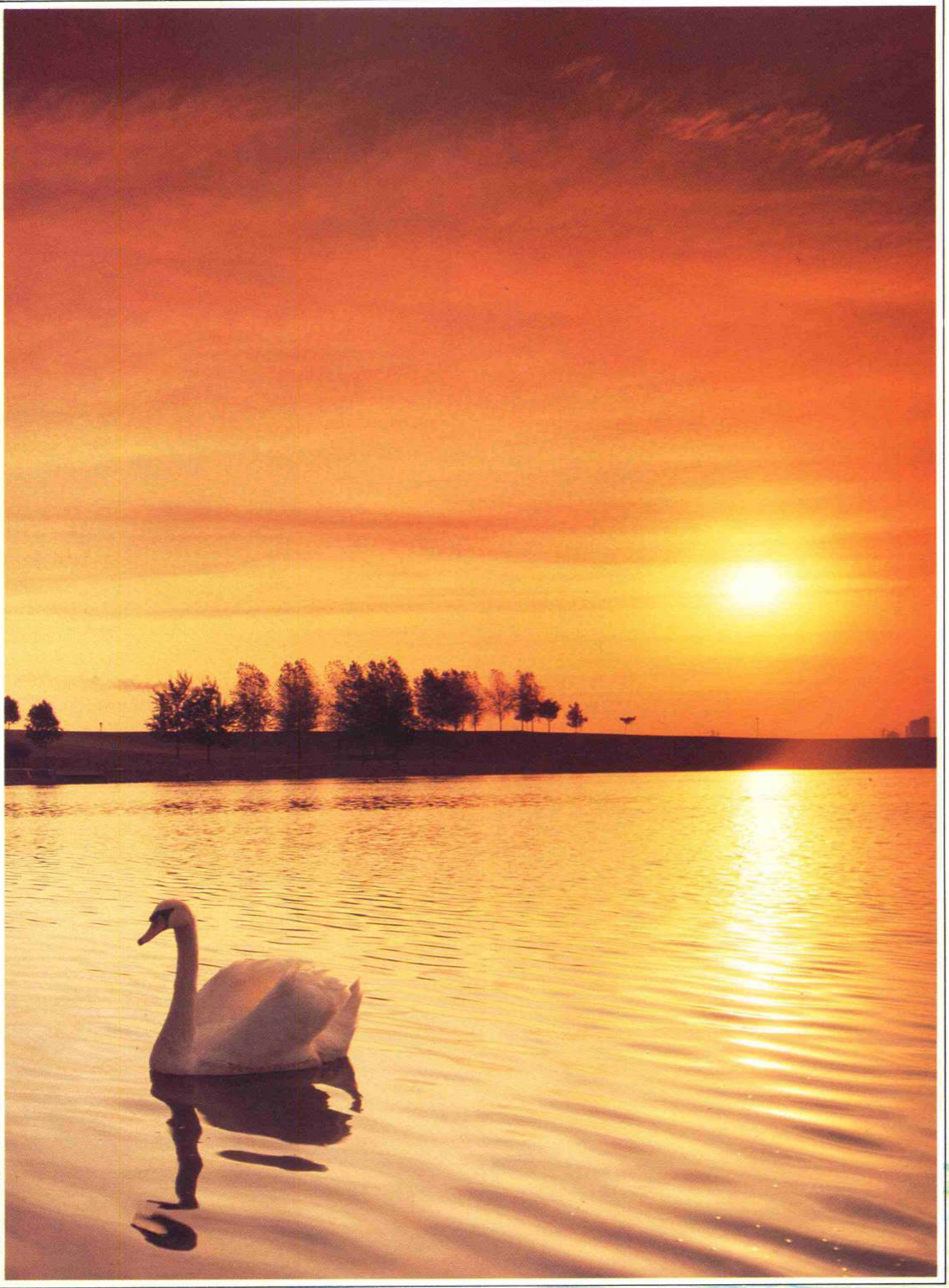
Thamesmead, 10 miles from Central London on the south bank of the Thames between Woolwich and Erith, is now halfway to completion. The riverside community, planned to provide homes in a green and spacious setting for about 40,000 people, is being built over a twenty-five year span.

Home-building on Thamesmead started in 1967 and 20,000 Londoners have already made a new life there. It offers the best of both worlds, equidistant from London and its job opportunities and the unspoilt countryside of rural Kent. The woodlands of Lesnes Abbey and Bostall Heath border Thamesmead. The unique 1,700 acre site, 3½ miles long and up to a mile wide (over twice the size of Hampstead Heath) needed major civil engineering work before it could offer today's opportunities to the home-seeker or the imaginative developer. Because of the constraints of the site, wild scrubland on a marshy terrain with its three and a half miles of river frontage to the north, development had to start from the southern perimeter, gradually moving inwards and to the north of the site.

A busy and successful community has already grown up in Thamesmead South with most of the facilities and amenities people need – shops, schools, churches, clubrooms, a post office, public library, pubs and health centres. The new areas now being reached by access roads and mains services will provide the setting for village-like clusters of houses with gardens, built in an interesting variety of styles and surrounded by parkland and woodland. Cycle paths free from other traffic allow carefree cycling and there is also a comprehensive footpath system.



1. *Room to Live: Housing at Windrush, Thamesmead Central.*
2. *Room to Play: Windsurfing on Southmere Lake, Thamesmead South.*
3. *Room to Grow: Thamesmead has some of London's finest schools.*
4. *Early morning peace and tranquility of Southmere Lake.*



Room to Relax

Lakes, canals and riverside

Southmere Lake was constructed as the first step in a network of waterways to provide an attractive means of draining this marshy site. Thamesmead now has five lakes, two of which are already used for sailing, and miles of shallow but navigable canals. Many of Thamesmead's new houses have or will have attractive canal or lakeside views.

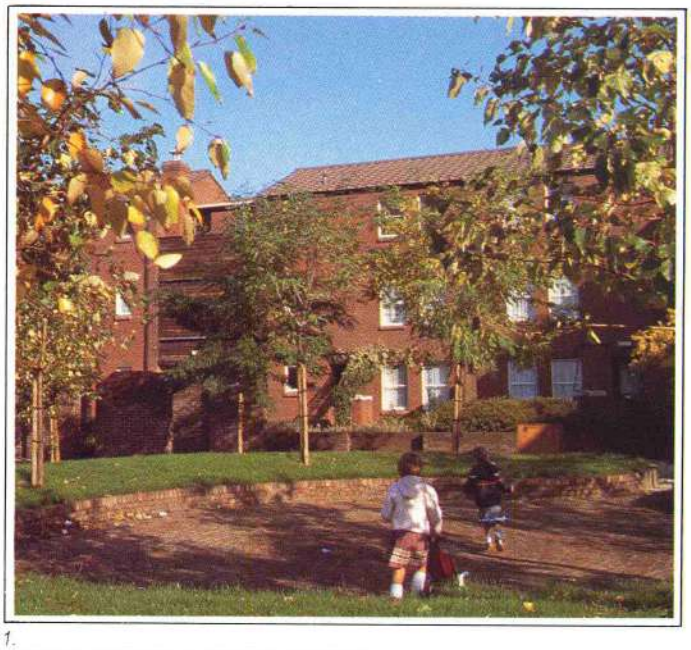


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The Thames flood defences have been rebuilt. Imaginative landscaping and pleasant walkways will be features of the new three-and-a-half mile river wall, part of which is already open to the public. Pumping stations on the river wall ensure that the Thamesmead lakes and waterways are kept at a safe level. The main pump house with its four giant Archimedian screws towering over the Thamesmere lake is a spectacular landmark.

Inland water recreation is centred on Southmere and Birchmere Lakes which both have car parking, changing rooms and club facilities for boating. Sailing, sailboarding and canoeing can all be enjoyed and fishing at Southmere Lake is already popular with anglers. Birchmere Lake is being stocked with fish and within a couple of seasons should also provide good sport. A new slipway on the river wall will allow dinghies and larger boats access to the Thames, launching from a concrete "beach".

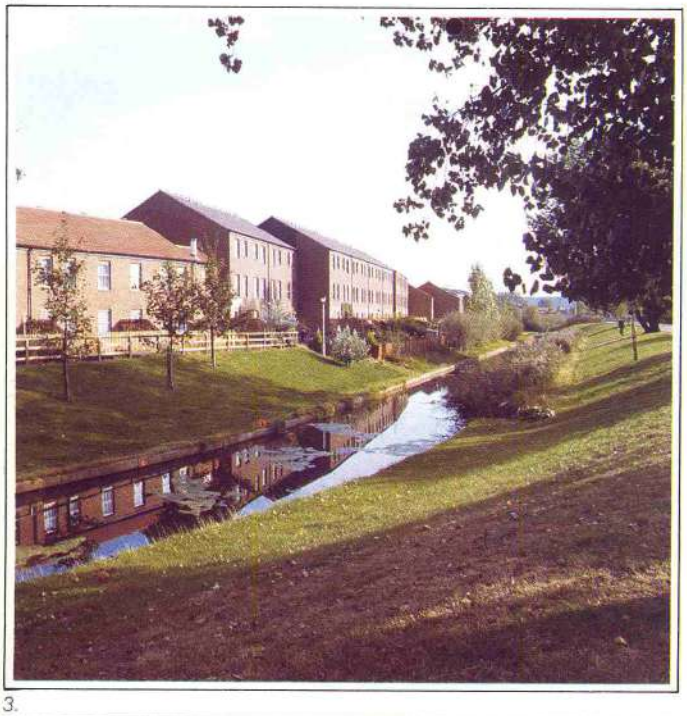
1. A fisherman's tale. Sunrise over Southmere.
2. Southmere Lake, a centre for sailing, windsurfing, canoeing and fishing.
3. Traffic free walkways meander through delightful landscaped areas.
4. Autumn colours at Southmere, Thamesmead South.
5. Family stroll in Lesnes Woods, on Thamesmead's Southern boundary.



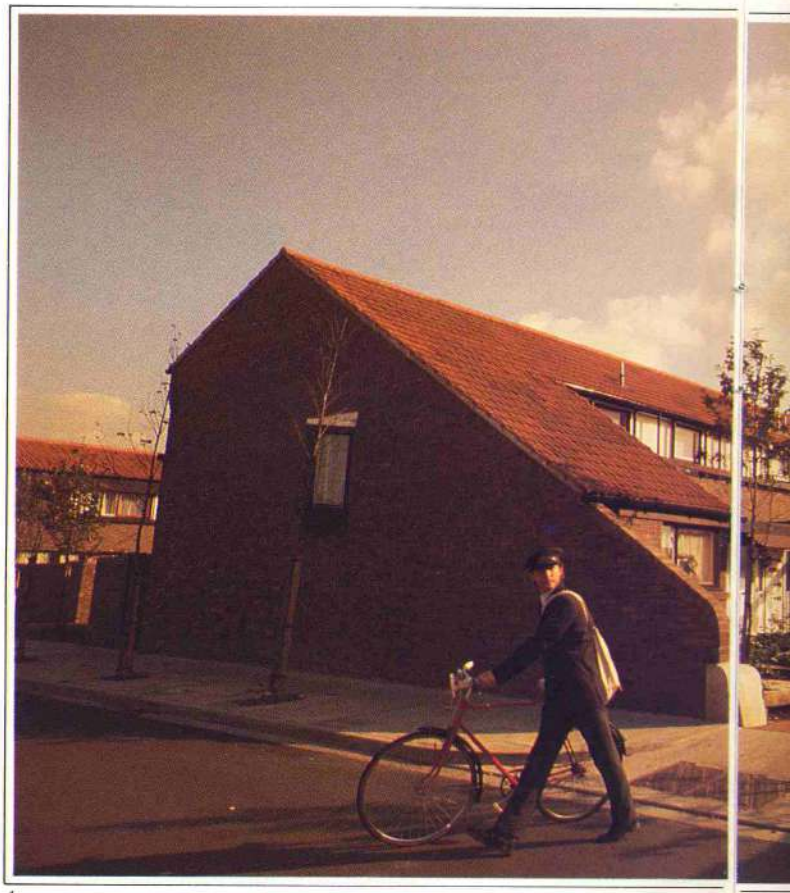
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Room to Live

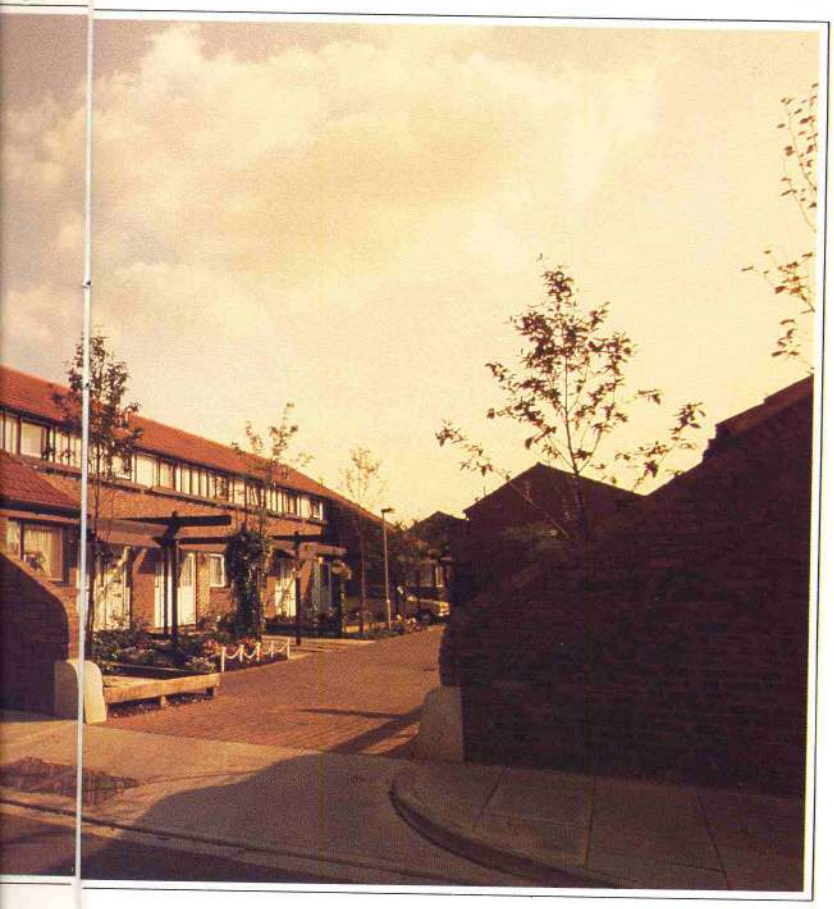
Homes in Thamesmead

Now the land has been prepared, the pace of housebuilding at Thamesmead can increase. But the difference between Thamesmead and the many ordinary estates in and around London, is the quality of life, the standard of design offered, and in particular the completeness of the concept, parks, social and industrial aspects all being included.

The original plans for Thamesmead's development have been revised by the Greater London Council to allow for a minimum population density of only 70 habitable rooms per acre. That really means space to breathe when you consider that, for instance, Lambeth has a population density of 122 habitable rooms per acre, and Southwark 125 habitable rooms per acre. Attractive clusters of new homes, all differently styled and individually varied are being built by carefully selected developers in Thamesmead North, Thamesmead Central and Thamesmead West.

Home ownership at Thamesmead can start with a small one-bedroom flat or a two bedroom "starter home". But all the new homes at Thamesmead, whatever their size or price, will share the benefits of skilfully landscaped surroundings, plenty of green parkland and lakeside, canal or river views.

1. *Moorings, Thamesmead Central.*
2. *Waterfield Gardens, Thamesmead Central.*
3. *Moat Gardens, Thamesmead North.*
4. *Manorway Gardens, Thamesmead North.*
5. *Manorway Gardens, Thamesmead North.*
6. *Manordene, Thamesmead North.*





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Room to Shop

Shopping in Thamesmead

Five small local neighbourhood centres for traditional "corner shop" service have already been built on Thamesmead and there are established shopping centres at Woolwich, Bexleyheath and Erith. The local neighbourhood centres have a wide range of shops and are set within traffic free precincts. All are within close walking distance of residents homes.

However, Thamesmead's own Town Centre will soon provide residents with a new shopping precinct on their own doorstep. Development by Town and City Properties plc, should start in late 1983 and plans for an attractive shopping and social centre, using warm natural materials like brick, tile and timber, with plenty of trees and shrubs.

The Town Centre will include a major supermarket, over a dozen different retail shops, a building society branch, a post office and bank, offices, a pub, a library and community centre and a petrol service station.

1. *Artist's impression of the proposed Thamesmead Town Centre.*
2. *5lbs of Potatoes please! Greengrocers at the Moorings.*
3. *Artist's impression of the Thamesmead Town Centre, featuring a 18th Century Clock Tower and Cupola rescued from the Royal Naval Dockyard, Deptford.*
4. *Neighbourhood shopping at Tavy Bridge, Thamesmead South.*
5. *Neighbourhood shopping at Greenmead, Thamesmead South.*



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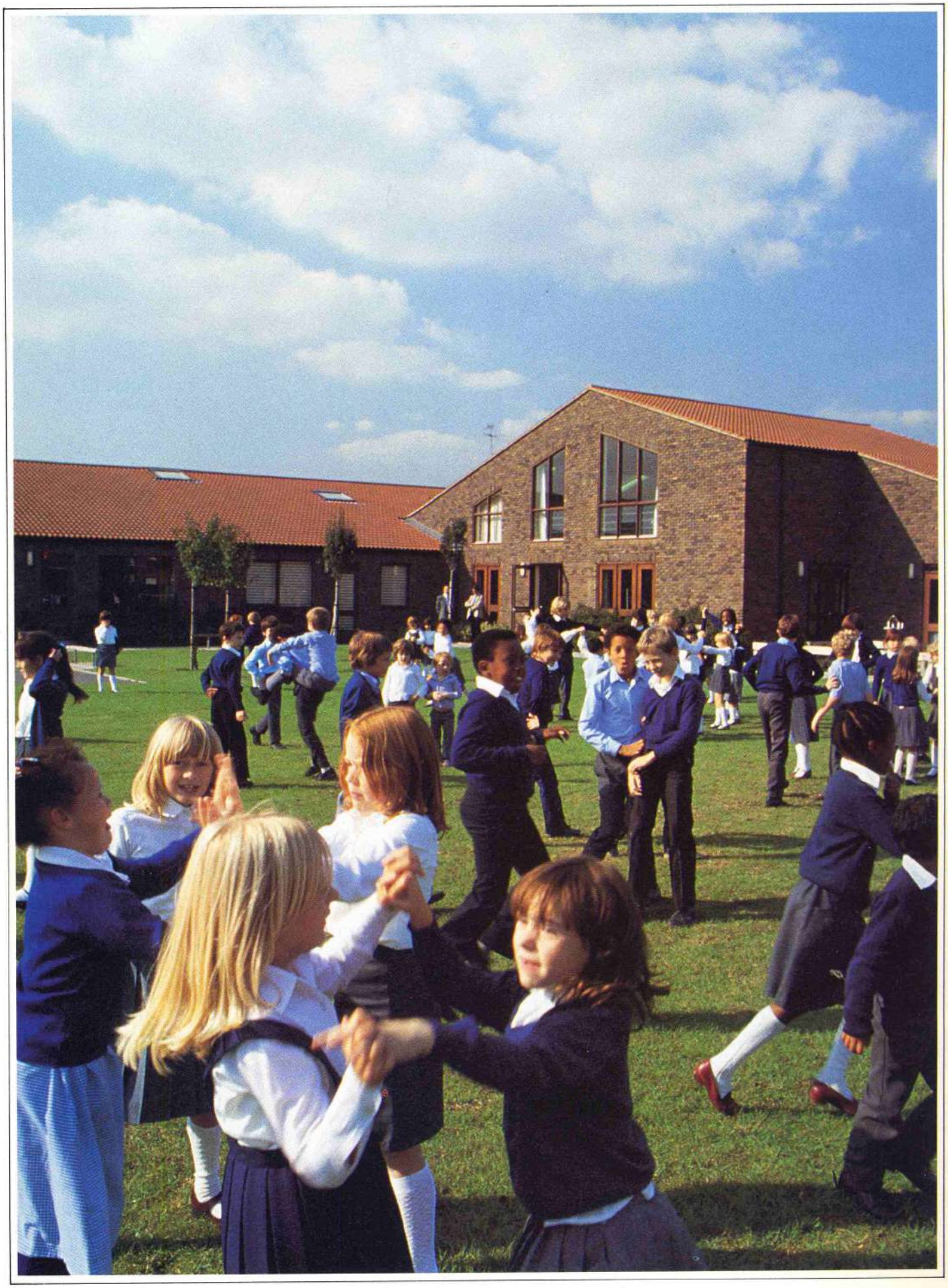


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Room to Grow

Education

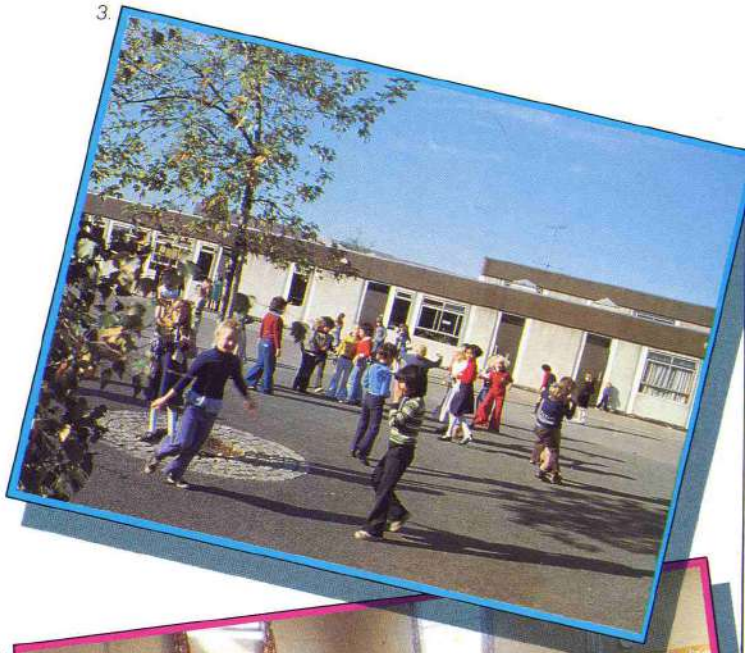
Thamesmead is a young community and predominantly a community of the young. There are eleven specially built primary schools, two of which are Roman Catholic and two new secondary schools, Riverside School (L.B. of Bexley) and Waterfield School (ILEA).

Thamesmead schools are among the most modern and best-equipped in the country with advanced facilities for acquiring valuable skills. Waterfield School has its own computer suite and motor workshops.

Pre-school education and play groups are actively supported. There are four nursery schools taking toddlers from the age of three and a number of mother-and-baby clubs.



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1. *Playtime at Northwood Primary School, Thamesmead South.*
2. *Who says school can't be fun?*
3. *Windrush Primary, Thamesmead Central.*
4. *Movement and dance at Southlake School, Thamesmead South.*
5. *Children can safely play in traffic free areas.*



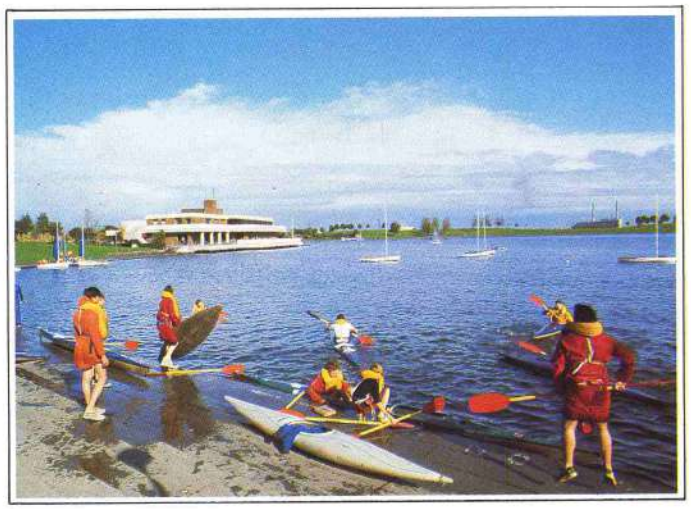
Room to Play

Leisure and community activities

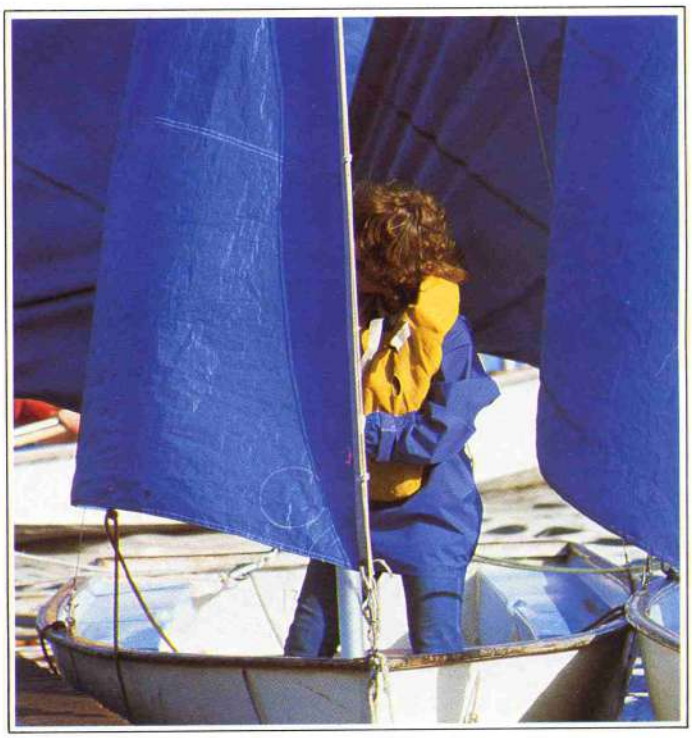
The Thamesmead Community Association runs three licensed clubs. Club activities include bingo and film shows. There are a number of thriving sports clubs, youth groups, Scouts and Guides, Cubs and Brownies.

The Thamesmead Football Club is well supported and plays in the Spartan League. Other organisations include the Arts club, the Athletic Club, Southmere Boating Club, Rivermead Riding Club, Thamesmead Canoe Club, Thamesmead Residents' Angling Association, Thamesmead Amateur Boxing Club, Peacemakers Western Club, Hawksmoor Youth Club, Waterfield Youth Centre and Thamesmead Youth Centre. Future leisure plans include a community theatre and a swimming pool

A truly local cable radio service is provided by Radio Thamesmead which started broadcasting in 1977. Radio Thamesmead now produces 40 hours broadcasting a week devoted to Thamesmead people and the Thamesmead scene.



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1. *Canoeing on Southmere, Thamesmead South.*
2. *Learning to sail at the ILEA Boating Centre.*
3. *Music at Lesnes Abbey.*
4. *Washday for one unlucky mum! Thamesmead Football Club fields many teams each weekend.*
5. *Lesnes Abbey Arts Festival.*



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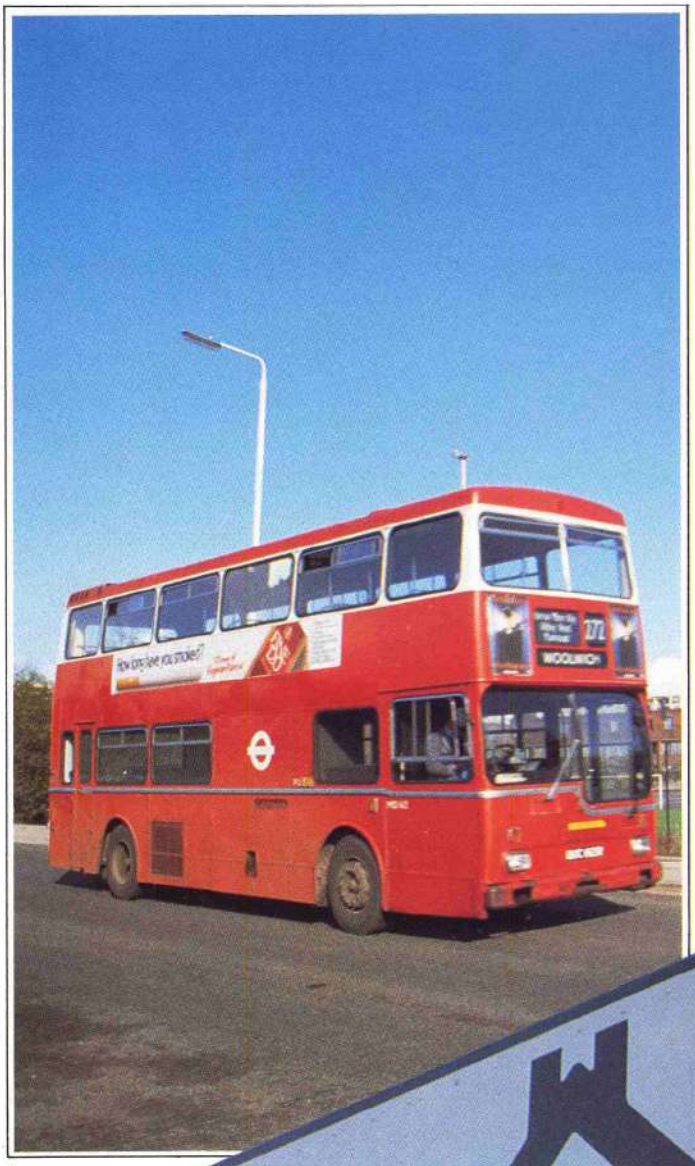
Transportation

Travel to Thamesmead

Thamesmead is on the south bank of the Thames, only 10 miles from Charing Cross and is linked to the north bank by the Woolwich free ferry and the Blackwall and Dartford tunnels. Dagenham is just across the river from Thamesmead and Fords, the major employer there, operate their own ferry.

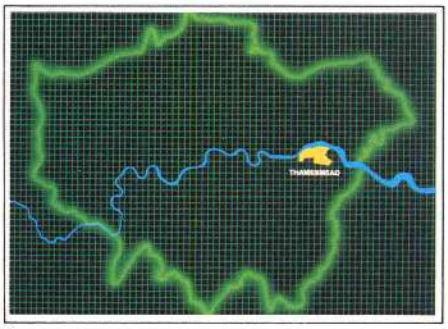
Thamesmead is 28 miles from Gatwick, 25 miles from Heathrow and within easy reach of the Channel ports, Dover being only 58 miles away.

Commuters find an electrified British Rail service to the City and West End with journey times of 20 and 30 minutes respectively and stations at Abbey Wood, Plumstead and Belvedere. The proposed East London River Crossing (to be built by the Department of Transport) will give direct access to the national motorway network.

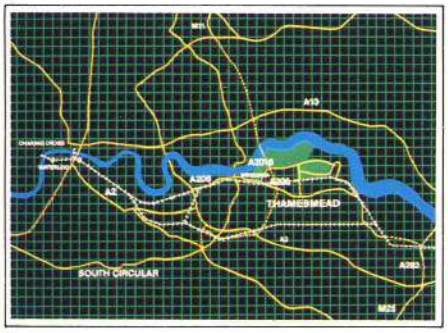


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1. *A regular bus service covers the whole of Thamesmead.*
2. *Thamesmead is conveniently situated in the S.E. of Greater London.*
3. *Thamesmead is well situated for all transport links.*
4. *Thamesmead road and rail links.*
5. *Not quite spaghetti junction. Nevertheless an important link of the Thamesmead road system.*
6. *The Woolwich ferry, easy access to North London.*



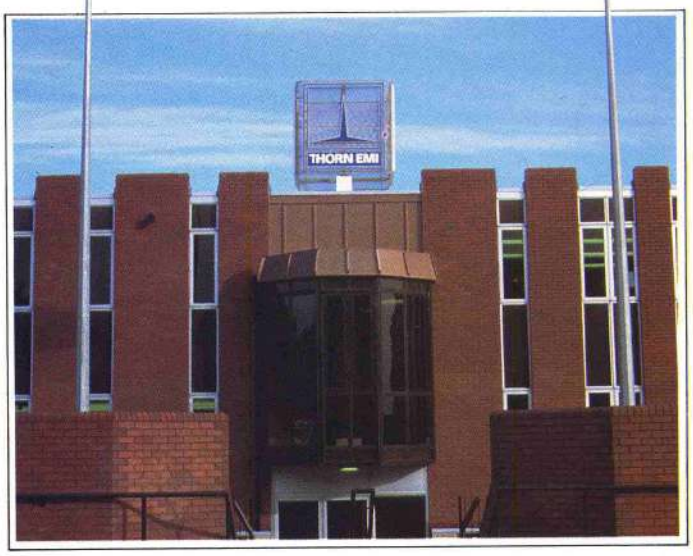
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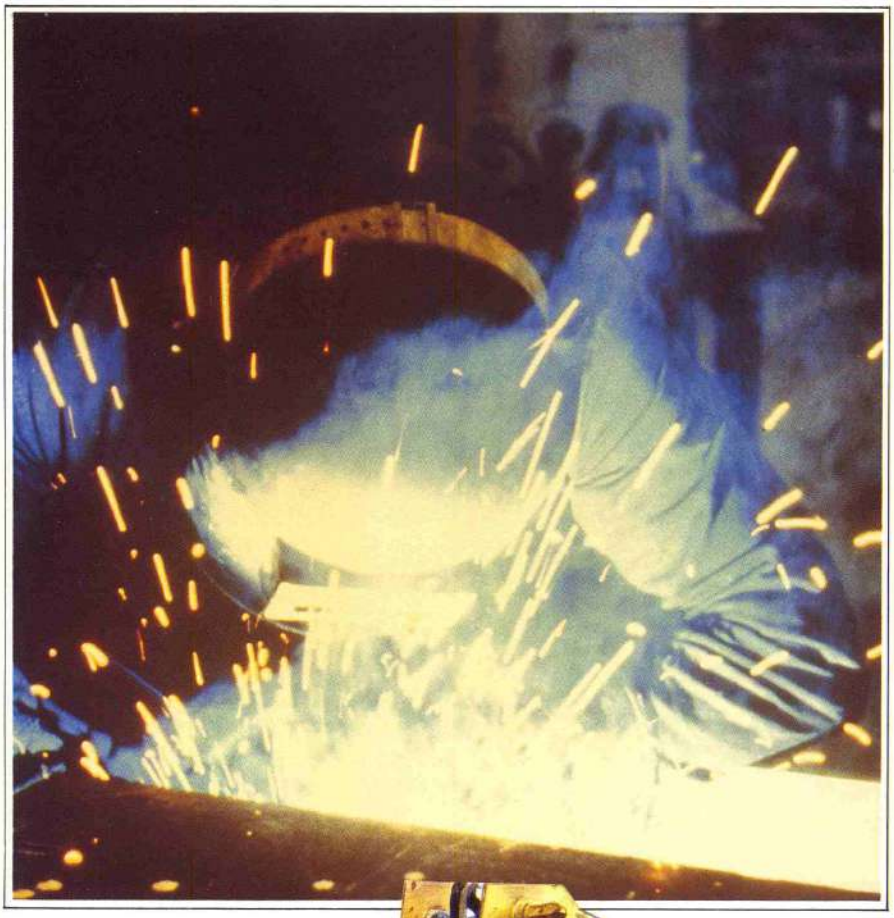
Room to Work

Jobs at Thamesmead

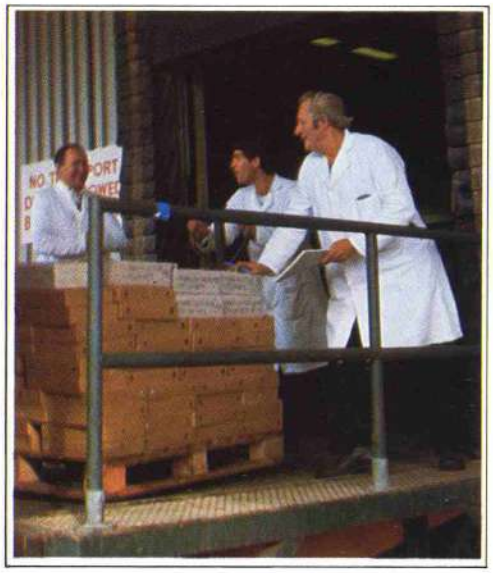
There are alternatives to commuting. Job opportunities at Thamesmead can be found either on the Eastern Industrial Estate or the Woolwich Industrial Estate/Plumstead area. Jobs near home have been found for almost 4,000 people in local factories and workshops, including small starter units. Large and small serviced sites for new employers are readily available.

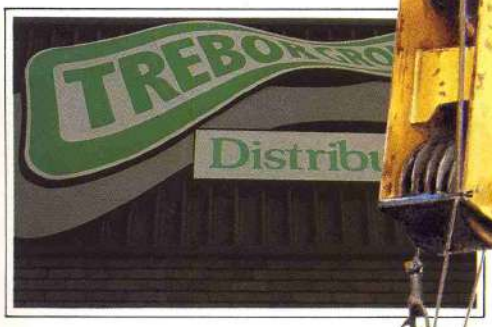
Leading firms who have chosen to build factories at Thamesmead are Trebor Sharps, J. A. Dewhurst Ltd and Keyswitch Varley, a subsidiary of Thorn/EMI. New firms encouraged to start up in Thamesmead's small unit factories should offer more varied opportunities as future development continues.







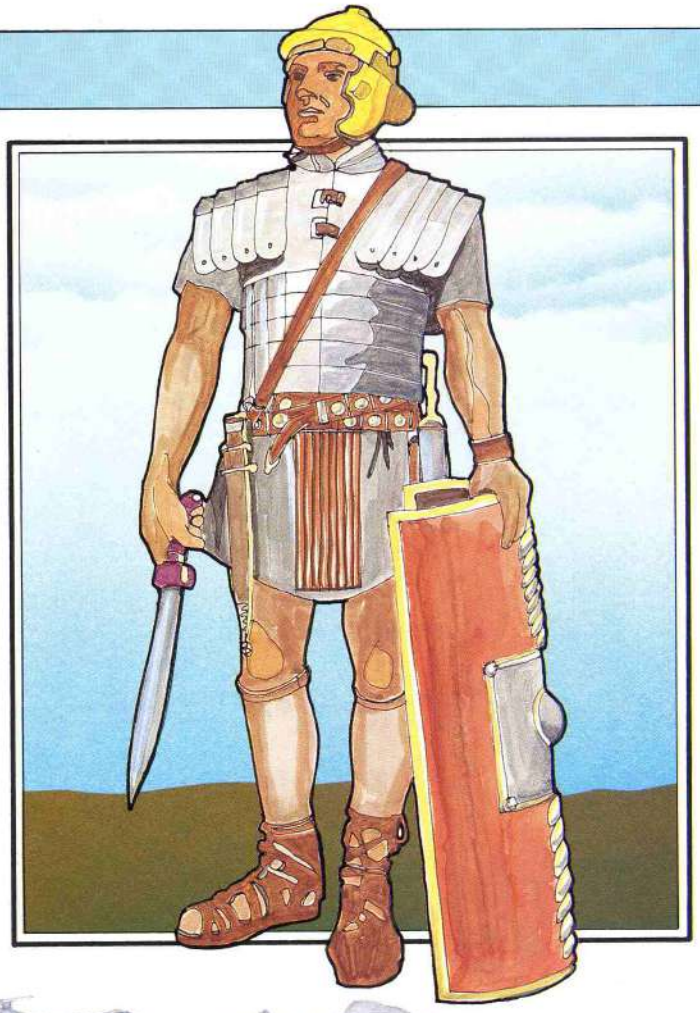



TREBOR


BEGG &
ThermoPlastic


DOWNS
PREMIER
FOODS


CRANE HIRE
LT41R



The Past

History of the Thamesmead site

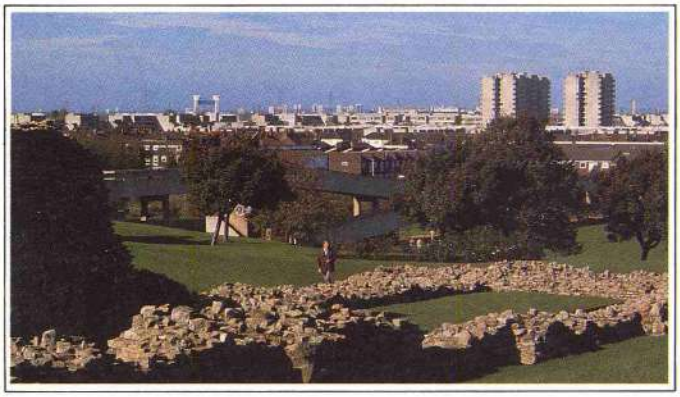
A glance into history shows why this area remained untouched by the hand of the developer for so long. It may have been the Romans who built up the original river bank and started to reclaim the marshy hinterland which now forms the Thamesmead site. There is archaeological evidence of a small Roman settlement nearly two thousand years ago at nearby Plumstead.

In the twelfth century Sir Richard de Lucy built Lesnes Abbey to the south of the site as a foundation for Augustinian Canons. The monks played their part in the reclaiming and drainage of the land probably until the Abbey was demolished in 1524. In 1530, the marsh lands suffered damaging floods but no satisfactory drainage was carried out until the GLC started work in the late 1960's. Originally the responsibility was assigned to the Commissioners of Sewers who raised a local tax called 'wallscot' to cover the expense of maintaining the river wall and draining the land.

Henry VIII established Woolwich Dockyard just up the river from Thamesmead. During the 17th century the area became a naval and military centre and later a brass foundry was built – the first time a manufacturing industry was established in the area.

Before Australia was colonised, convicts who received the equivalent of transportation sentences were put to hard labour in the area, one of their jobs being to fill up the swampy ground with mud and debris from excavations at St. Katherine's Dock near the Tower of London.

During the 19th century the site was incorporated into the Arsenal which was used for making and testing of guns and ammunition and supplying armaments. By 1890 it covered 323.7 hectares (800 acres) and included practice and experimental ranges. The War Office added 161.8 hectares (400 acres) of marshland where the Arsenal built a group of 'danger buildings' and a pier on the river bank linked to the main railway by a branch line. At this time 30 or more moated magazines, now known as tumps were built, some of which have been preserved as special features in the Thamesmead development.

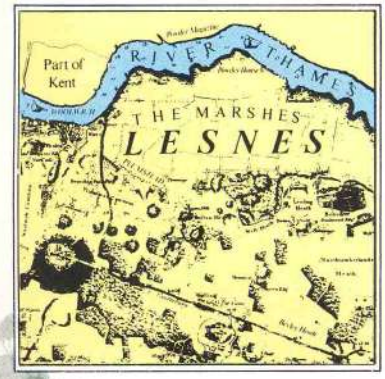


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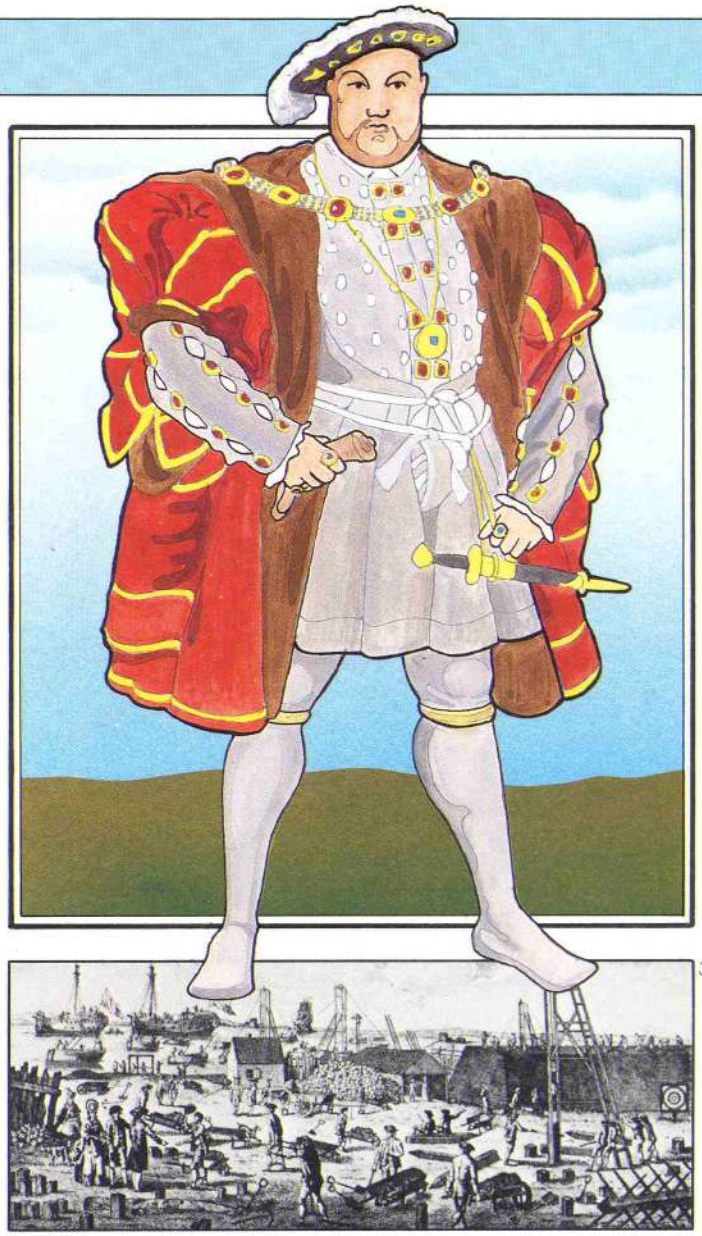
However, from the end of the First World War the Arsenal was run down because it lay too far from the sources of coal and steel supplies, labour in the area was scarce and therefore expensive, and the site was vulnerable to air attack.

By the early fifties the Arsenal was clearly under-used and land was purchased by the London County Council (succeeded by the Greater London Council in 1965) for the present Woolwich Industrial Estate.

Subsequently, the Ministry of Defence agreed to release all their surplus lands in the area to the LCC, to which further land was added making a total of 648 hectares (1,600 acres).



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1. *Past and present. The ruins of Lesnes Abbey, a relic of Thamesmead's historic past.*
2. *Old map showing site of Lesnes Abbey. (undated).*
3. *View of hulks and convicts at Woolwich, 1779.*



For information on Thamesmead telephone 01 633 7578.

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